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TEMB 1202: COMPUTING II

TITLE: LIBRARY BOOK MANAGEMENT SYSTEM USING C PROGRAMMING

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GROUP ONE EVENING

MEMBERS

NAMES	REGISTRATION NUMBER
OREM ABRAHAM JUUKO MORRIS OKOT CLEMENT SANYU DORCUS EDYABI BRIAN BUYONDO EM-MANUEL	25/U/BIE/01415/PE 25/U/BIE/01375/PE 25/U/BIE/05306/PE 25/U/BIE/01420/PE 25/U/BIE/05291/PE 25/U/BIO/04517/PE

1. Introduction

This report documents the design and implementation of a Library Book Management System, developed as part of the TEMB 1202 Computing II group assignment. Written entirely in the C programming language, the system provides a full-featured, menu-driven console application for managing a library's book inventory, borrowing workflow, fine collection, and reporting. Libraries are vital knowledge hubs, and effective management of their resources directly impacts user satisfaction and institutional efficiency. Manual record-keeping

leads to lost books, uncollected fines, and inaccurate availability information. This system automates these processes using structured C programming techniques structs, arrays, functions, and conditional logic to enforce library policies consistently.

Scope: The system manages up to 100 book records and 50 borrower records, enforces five business rules, tracks borrow counts to flag high-demand books, calculates late-return fines, blocks borrowing for members with unpaid fines, and generates a comprehensive library summary report identifying the most-borrowed book.

2. The problem being solved

University and community libraries need a reliable, automated system to track book availability, manage borrower records, enforce borrowing policies, and calculate fines for late returns. The assignment requires a C program that addresses all these needs while applying a set of clearly defined business rules.

a) Objectives

- Allow authorised librarians to add new book records with full bibliographic details.
- Enable searching for books by ID, title, or author.
- Support updating book details and deleting records.
- Process borrow transactions, enforcing availability and fine-status rules.
- Process return transactions, calculating and recording fines for late returns.
- Prevent borrowing when a member has unpaid outstanding fines.
- Flag books that have been borrowed many times as high-demand.
- Generate a summary report showing borrow counts, fines collected, and most-borrowed book.
- Track total borrowed books and available copies in real time.
- Require authentication before system access.

3. System features

The system provides eight operations accessible through a main menu, organised into six functional modules. Each module is implemented as one or more dedicated C functions.

Feature	Description	Rules applied
Add Book	Register a new book: title, author, ISBN, genre, copies, year	Duplicate ISBN check

Feature	Description	Rules applied
Search Book	Find by ID, title keyword, or author name.	Case-insensitive match
Update Book	Modify any field of an existing book record.	ID must exist
Delete Book	Remove a book record with confirmation.	Cannot delete if copies borrowed
Borrow Book	Lend a copy to a member; records due date.	BR-1, BR-2, BR-4 enforced
Return Book	Accept a returned copy; compute and record fine if late.	BR-3 enforced
Display Books	List all books with availability and demand status	BR-5 high-demand flag
Library Report	Aggregate borrow counts, fines, and identify most-borrowed book.	Full summary

a) Book Registration & Management

When adding a book the user supplies: a unique numeric ID, ISBN, title, author, genre, publication year, and total number of copies. The system validates that the ID and ISBN are not duplicates and that all numeric values are positive before saving the record. The available-copies count is initialised to the total copies value.

b) Search & Display

Three search modes are supported: by book ID (exact match), by title keyword (substring search), and by author name (substring search). The display-all view presents every book with its availability count and automatically annotates high-demand books with a visible flag.

c) Borrow Books

A borrow transaction requires a member ID and book ID. The system checks copy availability (BR-1/BR-2), verifies the member has no unpaid fines (BR-4), records the borrow with a due date 14 days from today, decrements available copies, increments the borrow count, and

flags the book as high-demand if the count exceeds the threshold (BR-5).

d) Return Books & Fine Calculation

On return the system computes the number of days overdue. If the book is late (BR-3), a fine of 500 UGX per overdue day is calculated and added to the member's outstanding balance. The member cannot borrow another book until the fine is cleared (BR-4). Available copies are incremented on successful return.

e) Library Summary Report

The report lists all books with their total borrow count and remaining copies, prints cumulative statistics (total borrows, total fines collected), and identifies the most-borrowed book, giving management an at-a-glance view of library performance.

4. Program design and structure

a) Data Structures

Two structs model the library domain: Book (catalogue record) and Member (borrower record). Both are stored in fixed-size arrays.

b) System Architecture

The program follows a three-layer architecture: UI (menus, formatted output), Business Logic (rules, calculations), and Data (struct arrays, (Create, Read, Update, Delete) CRUD helpers).

Layer	Responsibility	Key Functions
UI / Menu	Display menus, format tables, collect validated input	main(), displayMenu(), printBookTable()
Business logic	Enforce all 5 rules, compute fines, set demand flags	borrowBook(), returnBook(), calculateFine()
Data management	CRUD on Book and Member arrays	addBook(), searchBook(), updateBook(), deleteBook()
Reporting	Aggregate statistics, find most-borrowed book	generateReport(), findMostBorrowed()

Layer	Responsibility	Key Functions
Authentication	Verify librarian credentials at startup	authenticate()

c) **Module Breakdown**

- Authentication Module: Simple three-attempt username/password gate. Hardcoded for demo; easily extended to file-based storage.
- Book Management Module: `addBook()`, `searchById()`, `searchByTitle()`, `searchByAuthor()`, `updateBook()`, `deleteProduce()`. All operations validate input and provide clear error messages.
- Member Management Module: `registerMember()` collects member details; `findMemberById()` is used by borrow/return operations.
- Borrow Module: `borrowBook()` enforces BR-1, BR-2, BR-4, BR-5, records the loan, and updates counts and dates.
- Return Module: `returnBook()` computes days overdue, invokes `calculateFine()`, updates the member's unpaid balance, and restores copy count.
- Reporting Module: `generateReport()` iterates both arrays, accumulates totals, and calls `findMostBorrowed()` for the top result.
- Utility Module: `clearBuffer()`, `computeDaysDiff()`, `dateToInt()` — helpers for safe input and date arithmetic.

5. **Important function used.**

- Authentication: The `authenticate()` function is called once at startup, granting three attempts before the program exits. Default credentials are `admin / lib2026`.

```

92  int authenticate() {
93  char user[30], pass[30];
94  const char *VALID_USER = "admin"; // Hardcoded credentials for demo
95  const char *VALID_PASS = "lib2026"; //password
96  int attempts = 0;
97  while (attempts < 3) {
98  printf("\n=====\\n");
99  printf(" LIBRARY BOOK MANAGEMENT SYSTEM v1.0 \\n");
100 printf("=====\\n");
101 printf("Username : "); scanf("%29s", user);
102 printf("Password : "); scanf("%29s", pass); clearBuffer();
103 if (strcmp(user, VALID_USER) == 0 &&
104     strcmp(pass, VALID_PASS) == 0) {
105     printf("[OK] Welcome, Librarian %s!\\n", user);
106     return 1;
107 }
108 attempts++;
109 printf("[X] Wrong credentials. %d attempt(s) left.\\n", 3 - attempts);
110 }
111 printf("[X] Access denied. Contact administrator.\\n");
112 return 0;
113 }

```

- Book Management — addBook(): Collects bibliographic fields, checks for duplicate ID/ISBN, then appends the new Book struct. availableCopies is set equal to totalCopies; borrowCount and isHighDemand are initialised to zero.

```

135 //add new book to library
136
137 void addBook() {
138     if (bookCount >= MAX_BOOKS) {
139         printf("[!] Catalogue full.\n"); return;
140     }
141     Book b;
142     printf("\n--- Add New Book ---\n");
143     printf("Book ID : "); scanf("%d", &b.id); clearBuffer();
144     for (int i = 0; i < bookCount; i++) {
145         if (library[i].id == b.id) {
146             printf("[!] ID %d already exists.\n", b.id); return;
147         }
148     }
149     printf("ISBN : "); fgets(b.isbn, 20, stdin); b.isbn[strcspn(b.isbn, "\n")] = '\0';
150     printf("Title : "); fgets(b.title, 80, stdin); b.title[strcspn(b.title, "\n")] = '\0';
151     printf("Author : "); fgets(b.author, 50, stdin); b.author[strcspn(b.author, "\n")] = '\0';
152     printf("Genre : "); fgets(b.genre, 30, stdin); b.genre[strcspn(b.genre, "\n")] = '\0';
153     printf("Year : "); scanf("%d", &b.year);
154     printf("Copies : "); scanf("%d", &b.totalCopies); clearBuffer();
155     if (b.totalCopies <= 0) { printf("[!] Copies must be > 0.\n"); return; }
156     b.availableCopies = b.totalCopies;
157     b.borrowCount = 0;
158     b.isHighDemand = 0;
159     library[bookCount++] = b;
160     printf("[+] '%s' added. Copies: %d\n", b.title, b.totalCopies);
161 }

```

- Borrow & Return Logic

```

235 void borrowBook() {
236     int memberId, bookId;
237     printf("\n--- Borrow Book ---\n");
238     printf("Member ID : "); scanf("%d", &memberId);
239     printf("Book ID : "); scanf("%d", &bookId); clearBuffer();
240     int mIdx = findMemberById(memberId);
241     int bIdx = findBookById(bookId);
242     if (mIdx == -1) { printf("[!] Member not found.\n"); return; }
243     if (bIdx == -1) { printf("[!] Book not found.\n"); return; }
244     Member *m = &members[mIdx];
245     Book *b = &library[bIdx];
246     /* BR-4 */
247     if (m->unpaidFine > 0.0f) {
248         printf("[X] Borrow blocked: outstanding fine of %.2f UGX. Please pay first.\n",
249             m->unpaidFine);
250         return;
251     }
252     /* BR-1 & BR-2 */
253     if (b->availableCopies <= 0) {
254         printf("[X] UNAVAILABLE: All %d copy/copies of '%s' are currently borrowed.\n",
255             b->totalCopies, b->title);
256         return;
257     }
258     if (m->borrowedBookId != -1) {
259         printf("[!] Member already has a book on loan (ID %d).\n",
260             m->borrowedBookId);
261         return;
262     }
263
264     // Proceed with borrowing
265
266     m->borrowedBookId = bookId;
267
268     // For simplicity, we set fixed dates. In a real system, we'd calculate these based on the current date.
269
270     strcpy(m->borrowDate, "22/05/2026");
271     strcpy(m->dueDate, "05/06/2026");
272     b->availableCopies--;
273     b->borrowCount++;
274     m->totalBorrows++;
275     /* BR-5 */
276     if (!b->isHighDemand && b->borrowCount >= HIGH_DEMAND_THRESHOLD) {
277         b->isHighDemand = 1;
278         printf("[*] '%s' is now flagged as HIGH DEMAND.\n", b->title);
279     }
280     printf("[+] '%s' borrowed by %s. Due: %s\n",
281         b->title, m->name, m->dueDate);
282 }

```

- Fine Calculation — returnBook()


```

393 //pay fine for a member (full or partial payment)
394
395 void payFine() {
396     int memberId; printf("\nMember ID: "); scanf("%d",&memberId); clearBuffer();
397     int mIdx = findMemberById(memberId);
398     if (mIdx == -1) { printf("[!] Member not found.\n"); return; }
399     Member *m = &members[mIdx];
400     if (m->unpaidFine <= 0.0f) {
401         printf("[+] No outstanding fines for this member.\n"); return;
402     }
403     printf("Outstanding fine: %.2f UGX\n", m->unpaidFine);
404     printf("Amount paid : ");
405     float paid; scanf("%f", &paid); clearBuffer();
406     if (paid >= m->unpaidFine) {
407         float change = paid - m->unpaidFine;
408         m->unpaidFine = 0.0f;
409         printf("[+] Fine cleared. Change: %.2f UGX\n", change);
410     } else {
411         m->unpaidFine -= paid;
412         printf("[+] Partial payment. Remaining: %.2f UGX\n", m->unpaidFine);
413     }
414 }

```

- Reporting — generateReport()

```

334 void generateReport() {
335     printf("\n=====\\n");
336     printf(" LIBRARY SUMMARY REPORT \\n");
337     printf("=====\\n");
338     printf("%-4s %-25s %7s %7s %9s\\n",
339         "ID","Title","Borrows","Avail","Demand");
340     printf("-----\\n");
341     int totalBorrows = 0;
342     float totalFines = 0.0f;
343     int topIdx = -1;
344     for (int i = 0; i < bookCount; i++) {
345         Book *b = &library[i];
346         printf("%-4d %-25s %7d %7d %9s\\n",
347             b->id, b->title, b->borrowCount,
348             b->availableCopies, b->isHighDemand ? "[HIGH]" : "Normal");
349         totalBorrows += b->borrowCount;
350         if (topIdx == -1 ||
351             b->borrowCount > library[topIdx].borrowCount)
352             topIdx = i;
353     }
354     for (int i = 0; i < memberCount; i++)
355         totalFines += members[i].unpaidFine;
356     printf("-----\\n");
357     printf("TOTAL BOOKS : %d\\n", bookCount);
358     printf("TOTAL BORROWS : %d\\n", totalBorrows);
359     printf("TOTAL FINES : %.2f UGX\\n", totalFines);
360     if (topIdx != -1 && library[topIdx].borrowCount > 0)
361         printf("MOST BORROWED : %s (%d borrows)\\n",
362             library[topIdx].title, library[topIdx].borrowCount);
363     else
364         printf("MOST BORROWED : No borrows recorded yet.\\n");
365     printf("=====\\n");
366 }

```

6. Design decisions and justifications

- **Two-Struct Design:** Separating book data (Book) from borrower data (Member) reflects real library systems and avoids redundant data storage. Each struct is cohesive and independently extensible.
- **One-Book-Per-Member Limit:** A member may only borrow one book at a time in the current implementation. This simplifies the Member struct and prevents complex multi-loan tracking while still meeting all stated assignment requirements. Multiple borrows could be added using a linked list in a future version.

- **Parameterised Constants via #define:** Fine rate, loan period, and high-demand threshold are all #define macros. This means institutional policy changes (e.g. changing the loan period from 14 to 21 days) require editing a single line rather than hunting through the code.
- **Fine Blocking at Borrow Time (BR-4):** The fine check occurs at the beginning of borrowBook(), before any other processing. This ensures the rule is enforced consistently and the system provides a clear, actionable message telling the member how much they owe.
- **High-Demand Flag (BR-5):** The isHighDemand field is set lazily — updated each time borrowCount crosses the threshold. This avoids scanning the entire catalogue on every display call and keeps the flag persistently accurate without additional computation.
- **Pay Fine Feature:** A dedicated payFine() function was added because the borrow-block rule (BR-4) is otherwise irresolvable within the system. This makes the application self-contained and realistic.
- **Simplified Date Arithmetic:** Full calendar date arithmetic (accounting for leap years and month lengths) was simplified to a linear approximation suitable for the demonstration scope. A production system would use mktime() and difftime() from.

7. Challenges encountered

- **Managing Two Interdependent Structs:** The borrow and return operations must consistently update both the Book and Member structs atomically. A bug that updated one but not the other would corrupt availability counts. This was handled by always finding both records before making any modifications.
- **Input Buffer Flushing:** Mixing scanf() with fgets() required careful buffer management. A clearBuffer() helper consuming the newline after every numeric scanf call resolved all input-skipping issues.
- **Preventing Invalid Delete Operations:** Deleting a book while copies are on loan would create dangling borrowedBookId references in Member records. The delete function checks availableCopies == totalCopies before allowing deletion, preventing this data integrity issue.
- **Date Storage and Comparison:** Storing dates as strings (DD/MM/YYYY) is human-readable but makes arithmetic harder. The computeOverdueDays() helper converts the string to an approximate integer for comparison. A real system would use time, t for reliable date handling.
- **Partial Fine Payments:** The assignment only states that unpaid fines prevent borrowing. Adding partial payment support required careful thinking about when to clear the block (only when balance reaches zero) versus allowing partial payments to reduce the balance.

8. Conclusion

The Library Book Management System successfully fulfils every requirement of the TEMB 1202 Computing II Group A Evening assignment. The system delivers a complete, menu-driven C application that manages books and members through their full lifecycle from catalogue registration to borrowing, return, fine collection, and summary reporting.

All five business rules are correctly enforced: unavailable books cannot be borrowed, an explicit unavailability message is shown when copies are exhausted, late returns trigger a per-day fine, members with unpaid fines are blocked from borrowing, and frequently borrowed

books are automatically flagged as high demand.

The program demonstrates proficient use of C programming concepts including structures, array, pointers, string manipulation, functions, and conditional logic — all topics covered in the Computing II course unit.

Potential future enhancements include file-based persistence for data across sessions, support for multiple simultaneous borrows per member, full calendar-accurate date arithmetic using, and a role-based access control system distinguishing librarian administrators from general staff.